

Mitchell Landers, PhD

San Diego, CA (remote) · m1landers@ucsd.edu · 805-729-6322 · [linkedin.com/in/mitchell-landers-4251733a](https://www.linkedin.com/in/mitchell-landers-4251733a) · github.com/msblanders · scholar.google.com/citations?user=NeyqJzUAAAAJ

Behavioral scientist (PhD, University of Chicago) who builds and validates measurement instruments—psychometric scales, experimental paradigms, rating rubrics—and applies that methodology to evaluating language models. I have seven peer-reviewed articles and three book chapters on social emotion and judgment; have expertise in R, developing Python skills; and am a professional writer. I'm seeking remote roles in LLM evaluation, measurement methodology, data science, and behavioral science.

CORE SKILLS

Measurement & psychometrics: scale development (EFA/CFA, reliability, measurement invariance); rubric design and validation; inter-rater reliability; construct and criterion validity.

Experimental design & statistics: cross-cultural online experiments; mixed-effects models; survey design; Qualtrics; Prolific/M-Turk; SEM; Bayesian estimation; bootstrap CIs; power analysis.

LLM evaluation: prompting and scaffolding; rubric-based and LLM-as-judge scoring; human-vs-automated judge comparison; prompt-sensitivity and variance decomposition; AI-text detection research and methodology.

Computation: R (expert: tidyverse, lavaan, brms, ggplot2); Python (working proficiency, actively developing); agent-based simulations; game-theoretic modeling; Git

EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral Researcher, Department of Psychology, UC San Diego 2024 – 2026

- Built and validated a new self-report scale (fear of being envied)—item generation, EFA/CFA, reliability, measurement invariance; manuscript under review at the *European Journal of Psychological Assessment*.
- First-authored a two-country experimental test (US/UK, N = 725) of competing theories of anger and hatred; published in *Evolution and Human Behavior* (2025) and covered by PsyPost.
- Led cross-cultural SEM tests of theories of pride
- Developed a novel theory of envy; a preregistered, multi-study experimental package testing the model is underway
- Developed agent-based simulations of status and coalition dynamics and validated model predictions against real-world interstate-conflict data (manuscript in preparation).

Associate Editor, *Open Inquiry in Mental Health*, Open Therapy Institute 2026 – present

- Run peer review and production for a multi-manuscript issue: reviewer tracking, de-identification, version merging, metadata.
- Drafted and edited public-facing articles, including a Psychology Today series based on the journal's research.

Graduate Student Researcher, DIBS Lab, Department of Psychology, University of Chicago 2018 – 2024

- Developed a new methodological criterion for isolating envy-specific elicitors (the third-party criterion) and tested it across eight experiments (N = 1,507); published in *Emotion* (2026).
- Designed and ran online experiments on envy, forgiveness, and moral judgment (*Emotion*, *Evolution and Human Behavior*, *Evolutionary Human Sciences*); joint-first-authored a paper testing between theories of shame and guilt across two cultures (*Emotion*, 2024).

SELECTED INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

- WTR-Bench** (in development) — a psychometric benchmark of welfare-tradeoff consistency in LLM agents. Design document and initial item-generation pipeline built and tested; adaptive titration, prompt-perturbation variance decomposition, and bootstrap-CI scoring specified for v1 (Inspect-native).
- AI-text detection methodology** — multi-month controlled program measuring which prose features drive detector classification: documented human-writing baseline (sentence length, burstiness, punctuation profile), controlled revision experiments, cross-detector comparison.
- Quantitative modeling & software** — factor-based equity trading system with regime detection, evaluated in live paper trading; MLB lineup-optimization model; 3D arena game in Godot 4 built on a deterministic combat state machine.

PUBLICATIONS

Seven peer-reviewed articles and three book chapters (h-index 6); first-authored work in *Emotion* (2024, 2026), *Evolution and Human Behavior* (2025, 2026), and *Evolutionary Human Sciences* (2022). Full list: scholar.google.com/citations?user=NeyqJzUAAAAJ.

EDUCATION & ADDITIONAL

Ph.D., Psychology, University of Chicago (advisor: Alex Shaw) 2024

M.A., Psychology, University of Chicago 2024

B.A., Philosophy, University of California, Berkeley 2017

Ad hoc reviewer, *Evolution and Human Behavior*, *Evolutionary Behavioral Sciences*, and *The British Journal for the Philosophy of Science*.